



# A Brief Theological History

From Adam to Christ • From Christ to Reformation • From Reformation to AEPC

CREATION – FALL – REDEMPTION – CONSUMMATION

Prepared for viewers of the Africa Evangelical Presbyterian Church

## I. The One Story of Scripture

The Bible is not a collection of disconnected stories. It is one unfolding drama with four acts:

1. **CREATION** – God made all things good. Adam and Eve walked with God as His image-bearers (Gen 1–2).
2. **FALL** – Through Adam's disobedience, sin and death entered the world, corrupting humanity and creation (Gen 3; Rom 5:12).
3. **REDEMPTION** – God promised a Savior (Gen 3:15) and has been gathering a people to Himself through covenants, culminating in Jesus Christ's life, death, and resurrection.
4. **CONSUMMATION** – Christ will return to judge, renew creation, and dwell with His people forever (Rev 21–22).

## II. From Adam to Jesus (Creation to c. AD 30)

- **Adam to Noah:** God preserves a seed despite growing wickedness.
- **Abraham (~2000 BC):** 'in you all nations will be blessed' (Gen 12:3).
- **Moses (~1446 BC):** Law exposes sin; tabernacle and sacrifices foreshadow Christ.
- **David (~1000 BC):** Promise of an everlasting King (2 Sam 7).
- **Prophets:** Promise New Covenant and suffering Servant (Jer 31; Isa 53).
- **Jesus Christ:** Born of a virgin, fulfills the Law, dies as Lamb, rises, ascends. In Him CREATION's purpose is restored and REDEMPTION is accomplished.

## III. From Jesus to the Reformation (c. AD 30–1517)

- **Apostolic Church:** Pentecost births the church; gospel spreads.
- **Early Church:** Defends Trinity; Nicaea (325) affirms Christ is true God.
- **Augustine:** Teaches salvation by grace alone.
- **Medieval:** Tradition rises; East-West split (1054).
- **Reformation 1517:** Luther, Calvin recover *Sola Scriptura*, *Sola Fide*, *Sola Gratia*, *Solus Christus*, *Soli Deo Gloria*.



## IV. From Reformation to AEPC Founding to Today

- **1640s:** Westminster Assembly produces Westminster Confession of Faith.
- **1948:** Bible Presbyterian missionaries start work in Kenya, forming the Independent Presbyterian Church in Kenya.
- **1962:** After a split in the Bible Presbyterian Church, the minority missionaries in Africa formed the Africa Evangelical Presbyterian Church.
- **1964:** AEPC became independent.
- **Identity:** A conservative Presbyterian and Reformed church adhering to the Westminster Confession, headquartered in Nairobi, later spreading to Burundi, Tanzania, Congo and Zimbabwe.
- **2022:** About 100 congregations and 10,000 members.
- **Today (2026):** AEPC continues in Word, sacraments, and mission—living between Christ's first and second coming.

## V. Our Place in the Story

CREATION reminds us we are made for God's glory. FALL explains why we need regeneration, not just reform. REDEMPTION is our message: Jesus accomplished what we could not. CONSUMMATION is our hope: He will return to make all things new.

## VI. Why We Believe the Bible

At AEPC we do not hold the Bible as one option among many. We trust it because God has given good reasons:

### 1. Voddie Baucham – 'Because it's reliable and divine'

Pastor Voddie Baucham puts it completely: 'I choose to believe the Bible because it is a reliable collection of historical documents written by eyewitnesses during the lifetime of other eyewitnesses. They report supernatural events that took place in fulfillment of specific prophecies and they claim that their writings are divine rather than human in origin.' It was not written in a corner. The authors appealed to public events, miracles, and fulfilled prophecy, and they were willing to suffer and die rather than recant. We do not believe by blind leap, but because the Bible presents itself as God's own Word in real history.

### 2. Blaise Pascal – 'The Wager of Reason'

Pascal argued that reason itself pushes us to take Christianity seriously. If Christ is who He says He is, the gain is infinite and eternal. If not, the honest seeker loses little by living a life of truth, holiness, and hope. The wager does not prove the Bible, but it shows that ignoring it is the truly risky choice.

### 3. The Evidence Inside and Outside

- **Manuscripts:** We have thousands of early copies of the New Testament—far more than for any other ancient book—allowing us to know what was originally written.
- **Archaeology:** Again and again discoveries confirm biblical people and places (the Pool of Bethesda, the Pilate stone, the Dead Sea Scrolls), never once proving it false.
- **Prophecy:** Hundreds of specific promises—birthplace, lineage, suffering, resurrection—were written centuries before Jesus and fulfilled in Him.
- **Unity:** Sixty-six books, by about forty authors, over 1,500 years, on three continents, yet one coherent story of CREATION, FALL, REDEMPTION, CONSUMMATION.
- **Resurrection:** The empty tomb, the eyewitness appearances, and the birth of the church in Jerusalem—where the claim could be checked—best explain the facts.
- **Transformed lives:** From Paul to Augustine to believers in Kabiria today, the Bible continues to change hearts no human effort can.

We believe not by blind leap, but because the Spirit opens our eyes to see what is historically trustworthy, prophetically accurate, and spiritually alive. 'Faith comes by hearing, and hearing by the word of Christ' (Rom 10:17).

## Summary Timeline

| Period     | Key Moment                     |
|------------|--------------------------------|
| Creation   | God creates – very good        |
| Fall       | Adam sins – promise Gen 3:15   |
| c. 2000 BC | Abraham – blessing to nations  |
| c. 1446 BC | Moses – Law and Passover       |
| c. 1000 BC | David – eternal King promised  |
| c. AD 30   | Jesus – cross and resurrection |
| 325        | Nicaea                         |
| 1517       | Reformation                    |
| 1646       | Westminster Confession         |
| 1948       | Missionaries to Kenya          |
| 1962       | AEPC formed                    |
| 1964       | AEPC independent               |
| 2026       | AEPC continues today           |
| Future     | Christ returns                 |